

DecisionIQ Master Handbook

CHAPTER 5: Vision and Philosophy of Decision-First Analytics Design

5.1 The Decision-First Philosophy

Traditional analytics projects are built around data: *"What data do we have, and what charts can we draw from it?"*

In contrast, enterprise systems are designed around decisions: **"What business decisions do we need to make, and what data is required to guide those decisions?"**

Traditional Data-First Design:

[Available Data] → [Display Chart] → [Manager Guesses Action]

Decision-First Design:

[Strategic Decision] → [Identify Constraints] → [Prescribe Action]

5.2 The "So What?" Test

Every visualization and table in DecisionIQ is subjected to the "So What?" test before creation:

- *Developer*: "I want to show a line chart of daily website traffic."
- *Architect*: "So what? What decision does that guide?"
- *Developer*: "If traffic drops, we need to adjust marketing spend."
- *Architect*: "Then do not just show a traffic chart. Link traffic to conversion rates and CAC, and build a warning indicator that tells the CMO when to shift ad budget."

5.3 Student Projects vs. Enterprise Products

Recruiters review countless portfolios showing basic dashboards with default layouts and colors. DecisionIQ avoids this by framing every dashboard widget around an operational decision (e.g. "Which suppliers are at risk of contract violation?").